Notes on Reading Speed

Observation 1 concerns block 8 of the study. Further investigation should examine whether the same pattern holds for unfamiliar technical material. Where the model failed to converge, the simplest random structure that converged was reported instead. Participants read short passages on a screen while a camera recorded the movement of their eyes. The correlation between reading speed and accuracy was weak and varied across individuals.

Observation 2 concerns block 4 of the study. Short function words were often skipped, while long and unfamiliar words attracted several fixations. The measurement apparatus was calibrated before every block, and unreliable trials were removed. The distribution of fixation durations was strongly skewed, with a long tail of unusually slow responses. The analysis used a mixed-effects model with random intercepts for both participants and passages.

Observation 3 concerns block 11 of the study. Subjective ratings of effort rose steadily as the presentation rate increased. An important limitation is that the sample was drawn from a single university population. The measurement apparatus was calibrated before every block, and unreliable trials were removed. Readers who skimmed the opening paragraph tended to perform better on questions about the main argument.

Observation 4 concerns block 7 of the study. We compared three conditions that differed only in how quickly the next word appeared. Results are summarised in the accompanying figures, and detailed tables are available on request. The analysis used a mixed-effects model with random intercepts for both participants and passages. Notably, the slowest readers were not the least accurate, which argues against a simple trade-off.

Observation 5 concerns block 3 of the study. The analysis used a mixed-effects model with random intercepts for both participants and passages. We compared three conditions that differed only in how quickly the next word appeared. The measurement apparatus was calibrated before every block, and unreliable trials were removed. The correlation between reading speed and accuracy was weak and varied across individuals.

Observation 6 concerns block 10 of the study. Self-paced reading gives the reader control, but it also hides the moments where attention drifts. An important limitation is that the sample was drawn from a single university population. Short function words were often skipped, while long and unfamiliar words attracted several fixations. Taken together, these observations support a simple account based on limited working memory.

Observation 7 concerns block 6 of the study. Younger readers adapted to the faster condition within a few minutes of practice. Results are summarised in the accompanying figures, and detailed tables are available on request. Older participants preferred a slower rhythm, and their accuracy stayed high throughout the session. A high-frequency word is recognised faster than a rare one, even when both sit in the same position.

Observation 8 concerns block 2 of the study. An important limitation is that the sample was drawn from a single university population. The measurement apparatus was calibrated before every block, and unreliable trials were removed. Where the model failed to converge, the simplest random structure that converged was reported instead. Younger readers adapted to the faster condition within a few minutes of practice.

Observation 9 concerns block 9 of the study. The long-term effect of training remains uncertain because the follow-up period was short. Interruptions were rare, but when they occurred the reader usually returned to the start of the sentence. Self-paced reading gives the reader control, but it also hides the moments where attention drifts. Environmental noise was kept below a fixed level, and the room lighting did not change between sessions.

Observation 10 concerns block 5 of the study. Environmental noise was kept below a fixed level, and the room lighting did not change between sessions. Self-paced reading gives the

reader control, but it also hides the moments where attention drifts. We compared three conditions that differed only in how quickly the next word appeared. The measurement apparatus was calibrated before every block, and unreliable trials were removed.

Observation 11 concerns block 1 of the study. Taken together, these observations support a simple account based on limited working memory. Younger readers adapted to the faster condition within a few minutes of practice. Notably, the slowest readers were not the least accurate, which argues against a simple trade-off. The distribution of fixation durations was strongly skewed, with a long tail of unusually slow responses.

Observation 12 concerns block 8 of the study. We compared three conditions that differed only in how quickly the next word appeared. Taken together, these observations support a simple account based on limited working memory. Participants read short passages on a screen while a camera recorded the movement of their eyes. The measurement apparatus was calibrated before every block, and unreliable trials were removed.

Observation 13 concerns block 4 of the study. Where the model failed to converge, the simplest random structure that converged was reported instead. Notably, the slowest readers were not the least accurate, which argues against a simple trade-off. The experimental procedure was explained in advance, and every participant gave written consent. Younger readers adapted to the faster condition within a few minutes of practice.

Observation 14 concerns block 11 of the study. Younger readers adapted to the faster condition within a few minutes of practice. Environmental noise was kept below a fixed level, and the room lighting did not change between sessions. Further investigation should examine whether the same pattern holds for unfamiliar technical material. Typography had a measurable influence, and a larger typeface improved accuracy for the weakest readers.